

Dead in the Water — Cut-Out Cards

Print this whole document on plain paper. Each box below is one physical card. Cut along the horizontal lines. The “SETUP” header at the top of each card tells you where to hide it — trim that header off with scissors before hiding so the player only sees the content. Card IDs match the Clue Deck.

Also included at the end: Phase 1–5 search permits (one set per player) and accusation ballot slips.

HIDDEN CLUE CARDS

SETUP — CLUE 2-1 • □ANNOUNCE□

Hide: Living room — taped to the back of the framed nautical chart of Gig Harbor (the one with the cove circled in red).

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

A torn corner of paper, in Richard’s handwriting:

“...told her this afternoon. She took it well, I think. Better than I expected, actually. Maybe I underestimated her.”

SETUP — CLUE 2-2 • □KEEP□

Hide: Entryway — folded inside the inner pocket of Hank’s jacket in the coat closet. (Wait until Daniel hangs his coat.)

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

[**Physical prop:** a small snip of dark green tweed fabric, roughly 2cm × 3cm, torn-edged. Wrap it in a tiny slip of paper that reads:]

Fabric scrap — torn from a green tweed jacket.

SETUP — CLUE 2-3 • □KEEP□

Hide: Kitchen — tucked behind the cookbooks on the open shelves.

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

A typed letter fragment, on cream paper, signed at the bottom by an attorney whose signature is illegible:

“...final draft of the trust beneficiary, as discussed. Per your instructions, this version replaces all prior. I’ll bring the executed copy to the lake house Friday.”

SETUP — CLUE 2-4 • [ANNOUNCE]

Hide: Patio — under the upturned blue kayak.

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

EVIDENCE PHOTO — Sunday morning, 7:55 AM.

A damp footprint on the patio stones, facing the direction of the dock.

Size: MEN’S 11. Direction: toward the dock. Found by: A.

SETUP — CLUE 2-5 • [KEEP]

Hide: Living room — folded inside the small plant pot, tucked between the soil and the inner liner. (Use a plastic baggie if you’re worried about dirt.)

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

In Richard’s handwriting, headed “*Gig Harbor Visit — Final List*”:

1. Hank
 2. Catherine
 3. Beau
 4. Levi
 5. Cody
 6. [a name, smudged into illegibility]
 7. Eden
-

SETUP — CLUE 2-6 • [KEEP]

Hide: Kitchen — inside the freezer, taped to the bottom of the ice cream tub.

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

A grocery receipt from Friday. Customer name: *R. CROOKSHANK*.

Solomon’s birdseed — \$8.49 Glass-bottle root beer (case) ×2 — \$43.98 Tortoise figurine, ceramic — \$24.00 Peppermint tea, loose — \$11.50 Lobster forks ×3 — \$36.00

TOTAL: \$123.97

SETUP — CLUE 2-7 • [KEEP]

Hide: Dining area — taped to the underside of the bench with the decorative lanterns.

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

A balled-up cocktail napkin with a shopping list scribbled in pen, then crossed out:

plane tickets NYC reservations tortoise figurine GONE.

SETUP — CLUE 3-1 • [ANNOUNCE]

Hide: Patio — in the bonfire pit, in the cooled ash. (Singe the edges with a lighter over the sink before placing it.)

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

A partially burned page of typed manuscript. The visible text reads:

“...Aunt Catherine had always known the secret about her own mother, but the family pretended. She had decided this would be the year. The book would be her revenge wrapped in a memoir...”

SETUP — CLUE 3-2 • [ANNOUNCE]

Hide: Richard’s guest room — on the desk, slightly tilted under a small paperweight.

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

A handwritten thank-you note on cream stationery:

Mr. Crookshank —

Thank you for the book of your mother’s poems. It meant more than you know.

— E.H.

SETUP — CLUE 3-3 • [KEEP]

Hide: Richard’s guest room — inside the leather portfolio (which is now empty of the envelope).

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

A typed Saturday itinerary. Most entries are boring: *10 AM — boat ride. 1 PM — lunch. 7:30 PM — dinner.* The 3 PM slot has a handwritten note in Richard’s writing:

3 PM — Pull V aside. Tell her about T. Be gentle. She’ll understand.

SETUP — CLUE 3-4 • [KEEP]

Hide: Richard's guest room — top dresser drawer, under folded socks.

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

An envelope, opened. Addressed in Richard's handwriting to "Vivienne H." Inside, a letter:

My dear Vivi —

I read your last note. My answer is no, but let me explain. The theater is wonderful, but it doesn't pay rent in Manhattan, and I'm not in the business of subsidizing dreams. I love you for asking.

— R.

SETUP — CLUE 3-5 • [KEEP]

Hide: Patio — in the recycling bin, under newspapers.

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

[**Physical prop:** an empty glass-bottle root beer bottle. No card needed — the bottle itself is the clue. Make sure the label is intact and that there's no condensation on it.]

SETUP — CLUE 3-6 • [ANNOUNCE]

Hide: Gazebo — under the cushion of the wicker chair where Solomon's perch sits.

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

A torn page from the lake house guestbook. The visible lines, in a tidy hand:

Saturday —

Please let me know what you decide. Your support means the world. The kids in Cambodia need this.

— Bella R.

SETUP — CLUE 3-7 • [KEEP]

Hide: Levi's bedroom — under the mattress.

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

A creased boarding ticket:

LAKE SAUNDERS HOUSEBOAT MARINA Slip 14 Saturday Night Card
Game Check-in: 9:48 PM Guest of: WYATT P.

SETUP — CLUE 3-8 • [ANNOUNCE]

Hide: Bottom floor — taped to the back of the orca mural. (The mural peels forward; you can use double-sided tape on the wall behind it.)

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

A hand-drawn diagram of the dock layout on graph paper. The dock is sketched. The bonfire pit is marked. An arrow goes from the bonfire to the dock.

Annotation 1: “**11:30 PM**” — circled at the bonfire
Annotation 2: “**11:50 PM**” — written below at the bonfire
Between them: an arrow toward the dock, labeled in small letters: “~12 min walk”

SETUP — CLUE 3-9 • [KEEP]

Hide: Patio — under the *second* blue kayak (not the one with the footprint photo under it).

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

[**Physical prop:** a full case of glass-bottle root beer with one bottle missing. If you don’t have a case, use a six-pack and a small printed card that reads:]

*Case of Richard’s personal root beer. Eleven bottles remaining. (One missing.)
Found under second kayak Sunday morning.*

SETUP — CLUE 3-10 • [KEEP]

Hide: Bottom floor games area — wedged inside a Monopoly box, between the rules booklet and the lid.

— — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — —

A handwritten ledger page. Small, neat handwriting (Sebastian’s).

INHERITANCE (est.) - Crookshank Inns (sale): \$11.4M - Bainbridge house: \$2.1M - Liquid: ~\$500K = **\$14M**

OWED - MBA loans: \$312K - NYC apartment commitments: \$180K - Private placement deposit: \$750K = **\$1.24M**

Buffer ratio: 11.6×. Comfortable.

SETUP — CLUE 4-1 • [ANNOUNCE]

Hide: Dining area — inside the inner pocket of the navy blazer hanging on the back of Sebastian’s breakfast chair. (Plant when Jaymon arrives and hangs the coat. Get him to hang it under pretense.)

— — — — — — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — — — — — —

A heavy cream envelope. Notary stamp visible on the back flap. Addressed in Richard’s handwriting: “*Executor — Crookshank Inns Estate.*”

[Inside, a single sheet — also handwritten in Richard’s hand:]

I, Richard Carlton Crookshank, of sound mind and overflowing affection for the slowest creatures on God’s green earth, do hereby leave the entirety of my estate — Crookshank Inns, all twenty-three properties, the Bainbridge house, my liquid assets, and Solomon — to:

TURD: The Tortoise Urgent Rescue Division Olympia, Washington

Signed this day, the 14th of August. Notarized. — R.C.C.

SETUP — CLUE 4-2 • [KEEP]

Hide: Same blazer pocket as 4-1, folded behind the envelope.

— — — — — — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — — — — — —

A small scrap of paper, torn from a larger sheet. In Vivi’s handwriting:

11:35 — go

SETUP — CLUE 4-3 • [ANNOUNCE]

Hide: Primary suite balcony (upper deck) — propped between the cushions of the loveseat. (Place a hand warmer or a quick blast from a hair dryer on the lens before guests are upstairs, so it’s still “warm.”)

— — — — — — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — — — — — —

[**Physical prop:** a pair of small black opera-style binoculars. No card. The binoculars themselves are the clue. If you don’t have opera glasses, use any small compact binoculars and add a small tag:]

Binoculars found on primary suite balcony loveseat. Lens cap off. Lens still warm.

SETUP — CLUE 4-4 • [KEEP]

Hide: Master bathroom of primary suite — in the small trash can, under a few used tissues.

— — — — — — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — — — — — —

A balled-up sticky note. Smoothed out, it reads, in Vivi's handwriting:

breathe. it's done.

SETUP — CLUE 4-5 • [KEEP]

Hide: Bottom floor ping pong table — under the rim of the table on the kitchen-side. (Tape it lightly.)

— — — — — — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — — — — — —

EVIDENCE PHOTO — Saturday night, 11:35 PM.

[A photograph showing six people gathered around the bonfire: Hank, Catherine, Vivi, Beau, Eden, Bella. Vivi is mid-gesture, mouth open, telling a story.]

Photo by A. Bonfire group, 11:35 PM Saturday.

Note: Sebastian is not in this photograph.

SETUP — CLUE 5-1 • [ANNOUNCE]

Hide: Vivi's overnight bag. (You'll retrieve this in Phase 5 only, when Hank authorizes the search.)

— — — — — — — — — TRIM ABOVE BEFORE HIDING — — — — — — — — —

A draft of a letter, in Vivi's handwriting. Never sent.

To whom I am angry with —

Then I'll have to find another way.

— V

SETUP — CLUE 5-2 • [ANNOUNCE]

This is a re-issue of CLUE 4-2 (the "11:35 — go" note). If the player who found it in Phase 4 suppressed it, surface it again here. No new card needed.

PHASE SEARCH PERMITS

Print these on cardstock if possible. Hand each player their phase permit at the start of each phase. They can hold all five.

WHITFIELD LAKE HOUSE — SEARCH PERMIT PHASE 1 — Discovery Issued by:
A. (House Manager)

Open rooms: **Living room only.**

Please remain seated until I indicate otherwise.

WHITFIELD LAKE HOUSE — SEARCH PERMIT PHASE 2 — First Suspicions Issued
by: A.

Open: Entryway · Kitchen · Living room · Dining area · Patio · Dock · Gazebo · Bottom
floor

Closed: All bedrooms · Primary suite

WHITFIELD LAKE HOUSE — SEARCH PERMIT PHASE 3 — The Investigation
Issued by: A.

Open: All bedrooms · Richard's guest room · plus all Phase 2 areas

Closed: Primary suite

WHITFIELD LAKE HOUSE — SEARCH PERMIT PHASE 4 — The Unmasking Issued
by: A.

Open: **Everywhere.** The primary suite is now open.

WHITFIELD LAKE HOUSE — SEARCH PERMIT PHASE 5 — The Architect Issued
by: A.

Open: Everywhere. Including, where authorized, personal belongings.

ACCUSATION BALLOTS

*Print two stacks of 10 of each. Use the Phase 4 set for Sebastian's vote, the Phase 5 set
for Vivi's.*

WHITFIELD LAKE HOUSE — ACCUSATION BALLOT Phase 4 · First Vote

The person I believe killed Richard Crookshank is:

(One name. No commentary. Sign at bottom.)

Signed: _____

WHITFIELD LAKE HOUSE — ACCUSATION BALLOT Phase 5 • Second Vote

The architect behind the murder — Sebastian’s accomplice — is:

(One name. No commentary. Sign at bottom.)

Signed: _____

BONUS — The TURD Pamphlet (optional prop)

If you have time and want a closing-toast laugh, print this trifold or a single-page mockup. Leave it on the kitchen counter Sunday morning. Nobody will notice until Phase 4. Then everybody notices.

TURD

Tortoise Urgent Rescue Division

A 501(c)(3) Non-Profit of Olympia, Washington

Our mission. TURD exists because no other organization has prioritized the slowest, most ancient, and most unfairly maligned reptiles of the Pacific Northwest. Tortoises do not bark for help. They cannot. We bark for them.

By the numbers (2025). - **2,341** tortoises rescued - **17** “tortoise sanctuaries” in three counties - **\$60M** in projected major gifts

Our slogan. *“Slow is steady. Steady is righteous.”*

Founded 2024 by friends of the tortoise. Inquiries: info@turd-rescue.org

— end of cut cards —